

a brand out there in view of the public, garnering much-needed eyeballs for the business. And in this day and age, being out of sight is not just out of mind, but potentially out of business.

But the question of how to create great contagious content is a hard one to answer (alas!). That's not to say that some sort of a map cannot be created that will guide you to the answer. And the map-creation starts with understanding the reasons why people share social content to begin with.

Why do we share social content?

There is a seriously large number of people who make their living under the title, "Social Media Guru." The funny thing is that more often than not, if you consult two such gurus regarding the same problem, you are bound to get two different solutions, possibly veering in the opposite direction.

But as far as the question of why people share social content goes, even the gurus seem to have a few ideas they all share. And more importantly, scientific studies back these assumptions, raising them from the realm of theory to facts. Here then, are some of the key reasons why you share that cat meme with all your friends, without giving it a second thought.

1. To define oneself to others

Philosophers down the ages have tried hard to define a human- is it an agglomeration of senses, mind and everything that make the body? Or is the self the mind alone, or is there something that transcends the mind and the senses-the super self? These and many more are the theories that



Think like your audience

have been put forward to define the self, but the contemporary human being, at least the ones who are active on social media relies on him/herself to define oneself than any distant philosopher.

By sharing the content that they do, they reveal to the world-or at least to their friends, the values or ideals that they stand for, or the philosophies that they believe in, creating in the mind of others a picture of the kind of person they are. This way, we have the

"Religiously inclined"-the ones who share religious quotes frequently, we have the "politico"-who shares opinion pieces from newspapers like his life depended on it, the "entertainment nut" who likes nothing more